

# Lab 05 - Pathfinder, Shape Builder and Masks

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Course: Creating Professional Graphics with Adobe Illustrator (TGS-2021003160) Version: v11 | 21 August 2026

## Scenario

Develop a product badge that combines overlapping geometry, a clipped image treatment and a soft transparency option.

## Objective

Compare construction methods and select the most editable result for a badge system.

## Supplied Illustrator/vector files

- clipping.ai
- compounds.ai
- pathfinders.ai
- shapeBuilder.ai

## Detailed procedure

1. Open pathfinders.ai and save Lab05-Construction-Masks.ai.
2. Create the same core badge with Pathfinder and Shape Builder on separate layers.
3. Compare path count, editability and stray geometry; retain the stronger construction.
4. Create a compound path or shape that includes a deliberate counter or hole.
5. Use clipping.ai to build an image-in-shape treatment and a separate opacity-mask variation.
6. Inspect boundaries at high zoom, remove stray paths and document why the chosen method fits the brief.

## Evidence to retain

Editable comparison layers, final badge, clipping and opacity-mask variations and method rationale.

## Acceptance criteria

- [ ] The final badge has clean, intentional geometry.
- [ ] The chosen construction remains editable.
- [ ] Masks preserve source content.
- [ ] No stray or unintended paths remain.

## Reflection prompts

- Which decision most improved the message or focal hierarchy?
- How does the Layers or Appearance panel prove that your technique remains editable?
- What rights or provenance evidence must accompany the finished image?